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Data Driven Decision Making

Job Roles & Metrics: Whose shoes are you in?

Data Foundations · Term 2 · Session 1

Date: 19th October, 2026

THE BIG IDEA

A decision needs three things >>

Context
The company brief & About the data. How the business works & what each column means.

+

Question
The problem statement. A or B, by when, within what limit.

+

Evidence
The data. Rows that can actually answer the question.

=

Decision
What you do on Monday that you would not have done on Friday.

Miss one and you are guessing, until you build the missing piece. That gives three kinds of data problems.

THE THREE KINDS OF DATA PROBLEMS

Which kind of problem is it? >>

PROBLEM TYPE 1

Framework 1 · SOLVE

The full case

Company brief	GIVEN
About the data	GIVEN
Problem statement	GIVEN
Data	GIVEN

Like your term 1 BMQ Questions: Rapido, Meesho, Nyka...

PROBLEM TYPE 2

Framework 2 · DESIGN

The case with no data

Company brief	GIVEN
About the data	GIVEN
Problem statement	GIVEN
Data	NOT GIVEN

Day one of anything new: a new city, a first batch, a first hire.

PROBLEM TYPE 3

Framework 3 · DISCOVER

A lot of data, no context

Company brief	NOT GIVEN
About the data	NOT GIVEN
Problem statement	NOT GIVEN
Data	GIVEN

A founder's raw export and one line: "can you look at this?"

Flow of Today's Session >>

1. Why your role changes your analysis
2. The parts of a D2C business
3. Roles: who owns each part
4. Case: one problem, six parts
5. Build metrics in Google Sheets
6. Last 15 min: Mental Maths quiz

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Orders dropped 10% on Monday.

Who fixes it?

(Illustrative: 1,00,000 orders last Monday, 90,000 this Monday.)

Same drop, four different first questions >>

Product Manager
Did something break or confuse people in the app?

Acquisition Manager
Did an ad campaign stop or get more expensive?

Demand Planner
Were popular items out of stock?

Growth Manager
Did we get fewer new customers, or did old customers order less?

Which question is right? It depends on whose shoes you wear, and on which part of the business actually broke.

Four steps before any formula >>

1
Company
Which business am I in?

2
Part of the business
Which part does this problem touch?

3
Job role
Whose shoes should I wear?

4
Metrics
What does that person measure and act on?

Only after these four do we open the data. Today we practise steps 1 to 4 on a D2C company.

Step 1: Always have a company in mind >>

Whether you start your own business, or join as a Generalist or in a specific team, a data problem never floats in the air. It always belongs to a company.

D2C

Makes its own products and sells them straight to customers.

e.g. Mamaearth, boAt, Licious

Marketplace

Connects buyers and sellers and keeps a small cut of every sale.

e.g. Meesho, Swiggy, Urban Company

SaaS

Rents software for a monthly or yearly fee.

e.g. Zoho, Freshworks, Notion

The pre-read covered all three. Today we go deep on one: **D2C**.

Step 2: Every business has many moving parts

Let us open up a D2C start-up.

A D2C start-up in six parts >>

1
Sourcing raw material
Buying ingredients and packaging from suppliers.

2
Manufacturing
Turning the materials into finished products.

3
Marketing the brand
Telling consumers about the brand and winning customers.

4
Delivery
Getting the ordered product to the customer's door.

5
Customer problems
Fixing the issues customers face with their orders.

6
Repeat orders
Making existing customers order more and more.

Different parts. Different people. Different data.

Each part has an owner: the job role >>

Job role (or job designation) is the name for who does what.

Part of the business	Who owns it (job role)	Their one-line question
Sourcing raw material	Sourcing / Procurement Manager	Can we get the right material, on time, at the right price?
Manufacturing	Manufacturing / Production Manager	Are we making enough good product at a low cost?
Marketing the brand	Acquisition (Performance Marketing) Manager	Which ads bring new customers at a price we can afford?
Delivery	Logistics / Supply Chain Manager	Does every order reach the customer on time?
Customer problems	Customer Support / Experience Manager	What problems do customers face, and how fast do we fix them?
Repeat orders	Growth / Retention (CRM) Manager	How do we make existing customers order again and again?

CRM = Customer Relationship Management: keeping in touch with existing customers.

Some roles cut across the parts >>

These are the roles from your pre-read. They do not own one part; they connect several.

Founder's Office

Takes the biggest problem of the month, wherever it sits.

Chief of Staff

Keeps every part moving towards the same goals.

Program Manager

Runs a big project that touches many parts, like a new warehouse.

Product Manager

Owns the app or website experience, from first visit to repeat order.

Category Manager

Owns one category's profit and loss, like Hair Oil.

Demand Planner

Links the sales forecast to how much to buy and make.

Step 3: Put on their shoes >>

Change the role and four things change with it.

The question you are asked

Marketing asks 'which ad?'. Logistics asks 'which courier?'.

The data you open

Campaign table for marketing; delivery log for logistics.

The metrics you track

CAC for marketing; on-time delivery % for logistics.

The person who acts on your answer

The role owner, and the founder above them.

Founder, Generalist or specialist: before you solve, ask "whose shoes am I in?"

Case: Mamaearth, a D2C brand

One problem. Six parts. Six sets of shoes.

All numbers in this case are illustrative, made up to teach the idea.

Mamaearth: a D2C personal-care brand >>

The company

An Indian personal-care brand that started as a D2C brand selling skin, hair and baby care products online.
It decides what to make, who supplies the ingredients, how to advertise, how to deliver and how to keep customers.

The problem (illustrative)

Sales of a best-selling hair oil fell **15%** this month: orders went from 20,000 to 17,000.

You are a Generalist in the Founder's Office. **Which part of the business do you look at first?**

Which part could explain a 15% drop? >>

Part	What could have gone wrong	Data we would open
Sourcing	A key ingredient ran short, so the oil went out of stock	Purchases and supplier delivery dates
Manufacturing	A batch failed the quality check, so fewer units were made	Batch records and rejected units
Marketing	Ads stopped working or got costly, so fewer new buyers came	Campaign spend, clicks, first orders
Delivery	Parcels arrived late or came back	Order, shipping and delivery dates
Customer problems	Buyers complained and cancelled	Support tickets and issue types
Repeat orders	Existing customers stopped re-ordering	Each customer's orders over time

Six possible causes, six different owners. The data tells us where to look first.

PART 1 OF 6 · D2C START-UP

Sourcing raw material >>

JOB ROLE

Sourcing / Procurement Manager

THEIR QUESTION

Can we get the right material, on time, at the right price?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

purchase_id | purchase_date | supplier_id | material | qty_kg | cost_per_kg | promised_date | received_date

METRICS THAT MATTER

Cost per kg: what we pay for each kg of raw material

Supplier on-time %: deliveries that arrive by the promised date

Days of stock: how many days the material in hand will last

Why it matters: if material is late or costly, every step after it slows down or gets expensive.

PART 2 OF 6 · D2C START-UP

Manufacturing >>

JOB ROLE

Manufacturing / Production Manager

THEIR QUESTION

Are we making enough good product at a low cost?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

batch_id | batch_date | product | units_planned | units_made | units_rejected | cost_per_unit

METRICS THAT MATTER

Cost per unit: material plus making cost of one bottle

Rejection rate: share of made units that fail the quality check

Plan vs made: units made divided by units planned

Why it matters: poor quality brings returns and complaints, and a high cost per unit eats the profit on every sale.

PART 3 OF 6 · D2C START-UP

Marketing the brand >>

JOB ROLE

Acquisition (Performance Marketing) Manager

THEIR QUESTION

Which ads bring new customers at a price we can afford?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

date | channel | campaign | city | spend | impressions | clicks | signups | first_orders | first_order_revenue

METRICS THAT MATTER

CAC: ₹ spent to get one new customer

ROAS: sales earned for every ₹1 of ad spend

CTR: share of people who saw the ad and clicked

Conversion rate: share of clicks that ended in a first order

Why it matters: marketing is one of the biggest costs after the product, and the wrong channel burns cash fast.

PART 4 OF 6 · D2C START-UP

Delivery >>

JOB ROLE

Logistics / Supply Chain Manager

THEIR QUESTION

Does every order reach the customer on time and at a sensible cost?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

order_id | order_date | shipped_date | delivered_date | city | courier | delivery_status | delivery_cost

METRICS THAT MATTER

Delivery time: days from order to doorstep

On-time delivery %: orders delivered by the promised date

RTO %: Return to Origin: parcels that came back undelivered

Cost per delivery: courier cost for one order

Why it matters: late or lost parcels lose the customer, and the money spent on winning them.

Customer problems >>

JOB ROLE

Customer Support / Experience Manager

THEIR QUESTION

What problems are customers facing, and how fast do we fix them?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

ticket_id | order_id | created_date | issue_type | first_response_min | resolution_hrs | status | csat_score

METRICS THAT MATTER

Tickets per 100 orders: how many orders lead to a complaint

First response time: how fast we reply first

Resolution time: how long a problem takes to fix

CSAT: customer satisfaction score, usually 1 to 5

Why it matters: complaints are free feedback on every other part: a spike shows which part is broken.

PART 6 OF 6 · D2C START-UP

Repeat orders >>

JOB ROLE

Growth / Retention (CRM) Manager

THEIR QUESTION

How do we make existing customers order again and again?

DATA THEY OPEN (HEADERS)

customer_id | order_id | order_date | order_value | product | is_first_order | city | coupon_used

METRICS THAT MATTER

Repeat rate: share of customers who ordered more than once

Order frequency: orders per customer per month

Cohort retention: share of one month's new customers still ordering later

LTV: total profit a customer brings over their life

Why it matters: winning a customer costs money; repeat orders are where the profit comes from.

Part, role, metric, decision >>

Part	Role	Headline metric	The decision it drives
Sourcing	Sourcing Manager	Supplier on-time %	Which supplier to keep or add
Manufacturing	Manufacturing Manager	Rejection rate	Which batch or line to fix
Marketing	Acquisition Manager	CAC and ROAS	Where to move the ad budget
Delivery	Logistics Manager	On-time delivery %	Which courier to keep, city by city
Customer problems	Support Manager	Tickets per 100 orders	Which issue to fix first
Repeat orders	Retention Manager	Repeat rate	Whom to win back, and with what offer

Every metric ends in a decision. A metric that decides nothing is decoration.

Back to the problem: which metric moved? >>

Part	Metric	Last month	This month	What happened
Sourcing	Supplier on-time %	94%	93%	Steady
Manufacturing	Rejection rate	2%	2%	Steady
Marketing	CAC	₹310	₹320	Small rise
Delivery	On-time delivery %	92%	71%	Dropped sharply
Customer problems	Tickets per 100 orders	3	6	Doubled
Repeat orders	Repeat rate	28%	22%	Fell

Illustrative numbers. Delivery moved first and most. Complaints and repeat rate are likely knock-on effects, which we would test next.

The answer in three sentences >>

1. Hair oil orders fell 15% (20,000 to 17,000). The one metric that broke is on-time delivery: 92% to 71%.

2. Complaints doubled (3 to 6 per 100 orders) and the repeat rate fell from 28% to 22%, which suggests customers are leaving because of late parcels.

3. Logistics should find which couriers and cities slipped and move orders back to the reliable ones. We check on-time delivery daily until it is back above 90%.

WHO ACTS
Logistics Manager

WHO WATCHES THE KNOCK-ON
Support and Retention Managers

Illustrative case. In a real company the 90% target would come from the team.

Your turn: whose shoes? >>

In pairs, 5 minutes. For each line name the **part**, the **job role** and the **metric**.

1. Return-to-origin parcels doubled in Pune.
2. Instagram CAC jumped from ₹300 to ₹550.
3. Customers say the oil bottle leaks.
4. Only 12 of 100 buyers ordered a second time.
5. The supplier of a key ingredient delivered 9 days late.

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LAST 10 MINUTES

Mental Maths Quiz

